

children's inheritance while still providing stability for his new stepson. Everybody wins. Everything is clear.)

Money Mistake: *You Think You Can't Afford to Adopt*

The Fix: *Treat the Initial Cost as a One-Time Payment*

If you can't conceive, I have great news for you: you can still create the family you've always wanted. I have friends who have adopted multiple kids and love their families to pieces. Their children make their lives rich, bringing all the joys and blessings of parenthood—and all the challenges and financial burdens, too.

Deciding to adopt is a big financial decision. Most private domestic adoptions will set you back between \$15,000 and \$25,000 for a child born in Canada, and international adoptions (for a child born in the U.S. or another country) can range from \$25,000 to over \$50,000.

But if your heart is set on adopting, don't let those numbers scare you more than they should. It's really the same cost as having a baby: it's just that you pay more up front. With a biological child, that \$25,000 is spread out over the pregnancy and the first year of the baby's life. If your budget simply won't allow that one-time payment, consider a public domestic adoption, where there is typically no fee. Even in the worst-case scenario, you won't be paying more than \$3,000. Fair warning: the waiting period for a healthy newborn is extremely long. Many children available for public adoption are special-needs children. If this is something you're passionate about, by all means, go for it. But if you don't have the financial and emotional resources to take this on, consider other options.

Incidentally, I'm soon to be an adopted child myself. George, the man who has acted as my father for the last 50 years, is in the process of adopting me so that the Swiss government will formally recognize me as his son. I just celebrated my 59th birthday, making me the oldest man in the history of Ontario to be adopted. How's that for eternal youth?